

hypothesis

Domain Keys

■ What is it?

An e-mail standard proposed by Yahoo! that embeds an encrypted signature on outgoing messages.

■ How does it work?

It uses a pair of signing keys. The domain owner first sets up a key pair, and publishes a copy of the public key on the DNS. The private key is installed in the outbound e-mail servers. On receiving it, the public key for the domain name in the 'From:' field is obtained from the DNS. Using this, the private key's signature is verified. If it doesn't match, the e-mail is dropped; if it matches, the mail is delivered.

■ How will it help?

If all companies enforce rules that need all e-mail to be signed using DomainKeys, then spam could fall drastically. Spammers would need a valid domain address, and wouldn't be able to spoof addresses.

snapshot

Online groceries worldwide will see sales of **2.4 billion dollars in 2004**, which is **0.4%** of the total grocery market of **570 billion dollars**

Source: CNN

Yahoo!: 100 not out. Hotmail: Still on 2. Lycos: Already 1 GB

Google shocked the world with their 1000 MB free e-mail announcement on April 1. And no, it was not an April Fools' joke. With Google threatening to wrest the world's most visited Web site status from Yahoo! and MSN, the former had to do something, quick.

So, it came up with a 10 per cent me-too solution—Yahoo! will soon upgrade all its users to 100 MB of free e-mail space, along with Yahoo! Photos and Yahoo! Messenger. Yahoo! may have a headstart, though, thanks mainly due to the leader in the 1000 MB free space, Spymac.com, showing signs of glitches, and



Illustrations: Mahesh Benkar

subscribers are getting disillusioned too soon.

But guess who won the race for the most reliable 1 GB inbox. The almost forgotten Terra Lycos network that breached the tape.

Hotmail, meanwhile,

continues to be arrogant. It has not budged from its 2 MB free inbox service for years, and announced recently that it will open its inboxes to "friendly marketing communication", which essentially means more spam.

The question, then, is: With so many sites offering hundreds (and now, thousands) of MB of free space, can Hotmail afford to stay behind? Our guess is that it will have to shape up, or ship out. Soon.

By the Way, which is your favourite free e-mail service? Post your comments on the Forum on www.thinkdigit.com.

Not now, honey. I am playing my video game

And so we thought only kids play video games. And so, we were wrong.

In a survey carried out by the US-based Entertainment Software Association (ESA), it was found that a typical hardcore gamer is not your neighbourhood teenager, but his 12-years older brother.

The survey, based on a sample size of 1400 US families, and released at the recently-concluded Electronic Entertainment Expo (E3) in Los Angeles, said that the average age of gamers was 29, while most



buyers are aged around 36. Not surprisingly, however, men make up for 59 per cent of the playing audience.

Which leads us to ask: Did the recent Time magazine cover feature on failed marriages miss out on an very

important reason for the failure?

But the mother of all musical wars is yet to begin. With Sony announcing the download service called Sony Connect for uses of Sony Mini

Discmans, MTV might be a sweating a bit under the collar, even if it reaches 80 million homes world-wide.

Video may have killed the radio star. But surely, the online ring has place only for a few fighters.